

Grammar Worksheet — Tenses (Mixed)

Present · Past · Future — fill in the blanks, sentence transformation, multiple choice & cloze passages

Name: _____

Class: _____

Date: _____

Exercise 1

Complete the sentences with the correct form of the verbs in brackets.

1. I _____ (not see) my cousin since we _____ (finish) primary school.
2. While the chef _____ (cook), a customer _____ (faint) suddenly.
3. I'm sure it _____ (snow) tonight.
4. By the time the firemen _____ (arrive), the fire _____ (already destroy) the whole building.
5. Hurry up! The bus _____ (come). We _____ (be) late for school.
6. She _____ (promise) to help me yesterday, but she _____ (not call) me yet.
7. The shop _____ (open) at ten, so we still have time.
8. I _____ (work) on this project for two weeks and I _____ (not finish) it yet.
9. When I _____ (be) young, I usually _____ (spend) my holidays in the countryside.
10. By the end of this year, my father _____ (work) at the bank for twenty years.

Exercise 2

Complete the sentences with the correct form of the verbs in brackets.

1. Don't switch off the TV. I _____ (still watch) the news.
2. She _____ (lose) her keys, so she _____ (cannot) get into her flat now.
3. Last night, while we _____ (have) dinner, the lights _____ (go) out.
4. We _____ (queue) for tickets for an hour before the counter _____ (open).
5. The students _____ (already leave) the hall when the headmaster _____ (arrive).

6. I _____ (meet) John last week. He _____ (just return) from Australia.
7. She _____ (take) a rest now because she _____ (feel) tired all day.
8. Have you ever _____ (visit) the Space Museum?
9. They _____ (build) a new library near our school; they _____ (finish) it by next year.
10. This time next week, I _____ (sunbathe) on a beach in Thailand.

Exercise 3

Complete the sentences with the correct form of the verbs in brackets.

1. The phone _____ (ring) while he _____ (drive), but he _____ (not answer) it.
2. By the time you _____ (come) home, I _____ (cook) dinner.
3. I _____ (read) that novel twice already. It's brilliant.
4. She _____ (not be) to the cinema for ages because she _____ (be) too busy.
5. When the alarm _____ (ring), everyone _____ (run) out of the building.
6. He _____ (live) in this flat since 2018.
7. We _____ (wait) for the doctor for two hours and we _____ (still wait).
8. I _____ (never see) such a beautiful sunset before I _____ (visit) the island.
9. Don't worry about the tickets. I _____ (book) them online.
10. She _____ (study) in the library when I last _____ (see) her.

Exercise 4

Complete the second sentence so that it means the same as the first.

1. I last saw my friend two years ago.
I _____ my friend for two years.
2. The film began before I arrived.
When I arrived, the film _____.

3. She started learning French five years ago.
She _____ learning French for five years.
4. This is my first visit to Japan.
I _____ to Japan before.
5. He began reading at eight and is still reading at nine.
At nine, he _____ for an hour.
6. The baby is still crying.
The baby _____ crying since noon.
7. We have arranged to have a party next Friday.
We _____ a party next Friday.
8. It's likely that the typhoon will come this weekend.
The typhoon _____ come this weekend.

Exercise 5

Rewrite each sentence using the word in brackets. Do not change the meaning.

1. I was having dinner. The lights went out. **(while)**
The lights went out _____ I _____ dinner.
2. She had never seen snow before she visited Japan. **(until)**
She _____ snow _____ she visited Japan.
3. He finished speaking. Then he sat down. **(When)**
When he _____, he sat down.
4. I have decided to join the school choir. **(going)**
I _____ join the school choir.
5. We will probably finish the project next week. **(by)**
We _____ the project by next week.
6. Look at the dark clouds! It will rain soon. **(going)**
Look at the dark clouds! It _____ rain soon.
7. I started working here in 2020. **(since)**
I _____ here _____ 2020.
8. This is the first time I have tried scuba diving. **(never)**
I _____ scuba diving before.

Exercise 6

Choose the best answer for each question.

1. I _____ my homework when you called me last night.
 - A. do
 - B. was doing
 - C. have done
 - D. had done
2. By the time we reached the cinema, the film _____.
 - A. started
 - B. has started
 - C. had started
 - D. was starting
3. She _____ in this company since 2019.
 - A. works
 - B. worked
 - C. has worked
 - D. is working
4. Look! It _____. Take an umbrella.
 - A. rains
 - B. is raining
 - C. has rained
 - D. rained
5. We _____ a party next Saturday. Would you like to come?
 - A. have
 - B. had
 - C. are having
 - D. will having
6. I _____ three cups of coffee so far today.
 - A. drink
 - B. drank
 - C. am drinking
 - D. have drunk
7. While Mum _____ in the kitchen, I _____ my room.
 - A. cooked, cleaned
 - B. was cooking, cleaned
 - C. cooked, was cleaning
 - D. was cooking, was cleaning

8. The students _____ the hall before the headmaster arrived.
- A. left
 - B. have left
 - C. had left
 - D. were leaving
9. This time tomorrow, I _____ on a plane to London.
- A. sit
 - B. will sit
 - C. will be sitting
 - D. am sitting
10. He _____ his keys, so he can't open the door now.
- A. loses
 - B. lost
 - C. has lost
 - D. had lost
11. I'm sure our team _____ the match tomorrow.
- A. wins
 - B. will win
 - C. is winning
 - D. has won
12. She _____ the piano every day when she was young.
- A. plays
 - B. played
 - C. was playing
 - D. has played

Exercise 7

Choose the best answer for each question.

1. How long _____ you _____ here?
- A. did, live
 - B. have, lived
 - C. do, live
 - D. are, living

2. The baby _____ all morning. He must be tired.
- A. cries
 - B. cried
 - C. has been crying
 - D. is crying
3. Don't disturb me. I _____ an important letter.
- A. write
 - B. wrote
 - C. am writing
 - D. have written
4. When I _____ young, I _____ to school by bus.
- A. was, went
 - B. am, go
 - C. was, was going
 - D. have been, went
5. She _____ a shower when the earthquake happened.
- A. takes
 - B. took
 - C. was taking
 - D. has taken
6. We _____ our new house by the end of this month.
- A. move into
 - B. will move into
 - C. will have moved into
 - D. are moving into
7. I _____ never _____ such a funny film before.
- A. have, seen
 - B. had, seen
 - C. did, see
 - D. was, seeing
8. The train _____ at 7:30 every morning.
- A. leave
 - B. leaves
 - C. is leaving
 - D. left

9. He _____ for ten years before he retired.

- A. taught
- B. has taught
- C. had taught
- D. was teaching

10. _____ you _____ the new library yet?

- A. Have, visited
- B. Did, visit
- C. Do, visit
- D. Are, visiting

11. It _____. The ground is wet.

- A. rained
- B. was raining
- C. has rained
- D. had rained

12. Look out! That car _____ hit you!

- A. will
- B. is going to
- C. is
- D. was going to

Exercise 8

Complete the passage with the correct form of the verbs in brackets.

When I ⁽¹⁾ _____ (be) fourteen, my father ⁽²⁾ _____ (take) me on my first camping trip in Sai Kung. We ⁽³⁾ _____ (plan) the trip for weeks, and I ⁽⁴⁾ _____ (look forward) to it eagerly. On the day of departure, however, I ⁽⁵⁾ _____ (oversleep) because my alarm clock ⁽⁶⁾ _____ (stop) working during the night. By the time we ⁽⁷⁾ _____ (leave) the house, the sky ⁽⁸⁾ _____ (already turn) grey.

"Don't worry," my father ⁽⁹⁾ _____ (say). "The weather ⁽¹⁰⁾ _____ (improve) later." I ⁽¹¹⁾ _____ (not believe) him, but I ⁽¹²⁾ _____ (decide) to stay positive. While we ⁽¹³⁾ _____ (drive) along the winding country road, heavy rain suddenly ⁽¹⁴⁾ _____ (pour) down. The visibility ⁽¹⁵⁾ _____ (become) so poor that my father

(16) _____ (have) to pull over. We (17) _____ (sit) in the car for nearly two hours, listening to the thunder. I (18) _____ (never feel) so disappointed in my life. Eventually, the rain (19) _____ (ease) and we (20) _____ (reach) the campsite late in the evening, exhausted but relieved. Since that trip, I (21) _____ (always pack) a spare alarm clock whenever I go camping.

Exercise 9

Complete the passage with the correct form of the verbs in brackets.

This summer, I (1) _____ (decide) to look for a part-time job instead of staying at home. For years, I (2) _____ (rely) on my parents for pocket money, and I (3) _____ (want) to become more independent. After I (4) _____ (send) out more than ten applications, a small café finally (5) _____ (call) me for an interview.

On the day of the interview, I (6) _____ (wake) up extra early. I (7) _____ (practise) answering common interview questions all week, so I (8) _____ (feel) fairly confident. However, when I (9) _____ (arrive), the manager (10) _____ (already interview) two other candidates. I (11) _____ (wait) nervously outside for what felt like forever. Just as I (12) _____ (wonder) whether I should give up, the door (13) _____ (open) and the manager (14) _____ (call) my name.

“Relax,” she (15) _____ (smile). “We (16) _____ (decide) to hire you already. You (17) _____ (be) the most enthusiastic applicant we (18) _____ (ever meet).”

I could hardly believe it. I (19) _____ (work) at the café for a month now, and I (20) _____ (enjoy) every moment. Next week, I (21) _____ (use) my first salary to buy my mother a birthday present. I am sure she (22) _____ (be) proud of me.

Exercise 10

Complete the passage with the correct form of the verbs in brackets.

Last Friday (1) _____ (be) the day of the inter-school basketball final. Our team (2) _____ (prepare) for this match for the whole year. We (3) _____ (train) every evening, and our coach (4) _____ (never let) us rest until we (5) _____ (perfect) every move.

In the first half, we ⁽⁶⁾ _____ (play) terribly. By half-time, the other team ⁽⁷⁾ _____ (already score) twenty more points than us. While we ⁽⁸⁾ _____ (sit) in the changing room, our captain ⁽⁹⁾ _____ (give) an inspiring speech. "We ⁽¹⁰⁾ _____ (not lose) this match," he ⁽¹¹⁾ _____ (shout). "We ⁽¹²⁾ _____ (come) this far, and we ⁽¹³⁾ _____ (not throw) it away now."

The second half ⁽¹⁴⁾ _____ (be) completely different. We ⁽¹⁵⁾ _____ (play) with such energy that the crowd ⁽¹⁶⁾ _____ (cheer) wildly. With only ten seconds left, I ⁽¹⁷⁾ _____ (manage) to score the winning basket. The moment I ⁽¹⁸⁾ _____ (do) that, the whole gymnasium ⁽¹⁹⁾ _____ (erupt). I ⁽²⁰⁾ _____ (never feel) such joy before. Even now, I ⁽²¹⁾ _____ (still remember) every detail of that afternoon. It ⁽²²⁾ _____ (remain) one of the happiest moments of my life.

Answer Key — Tenses

Exercise 1

1. haven't seen, finished
2. was cooking, fainted
3. will snow
4. arrived, had already destroyed
5. is coming, will be
6. promised, hasn't called
7. opens
8. have been working, haven't finished
9. was, spent
10. will have been working

Exercise 2

1. am still watching
2. has lost, cannot
3. were having, went
4. had been queuing, opened
5. had already left, arrived
6. met, had just returned
7. is taking, has been feeling
8. visited
9. are building, will have finished
10. will be sunbathing

Exercise 3

1. rang, was driving, didn't answer
2. come, will have cooked
3. have read
4. hasn't been, has been
5. rang, ran
6. has lived
7. have been waiting, are still waiting
8. had never seen, visited
9. will book

10. was studying, saw

Exercise 4

1. haven't seen
2. had already begun
3. has been
4. have never been
5. has been reading
6. has been
7. are having
8. will probably

Exercise 5

1. while, was having
2. had never seen, until
3. had spoken
4. am going to
5. will have finished
6. is going to
7. have worked, since
8. have never tried

Exercise 6

1. B (was doing)
2. C (had started)
3. C (has worked)
4. B (is raining)
5. C (are having)
6. D (have drunk)
7. D (was cooking, was cleaning)
8. C (had left)
9. C (will be sitting)
10. C (has lost)
11. B (will win)
12. B (played)

Exercise 7

1. B (have, lived)
2. C (has been crying)
3. C (am writing)
4. A (was, went)
5. C (was taking)
6. C (will have moved into)
7. A (have, seen)
8. B (leaves)
9. C (had taught)
10. A (Have, visited)
11. C (has rained)
12. B (is going to)

Exercise 8

1. was
2. took
3. had been planning
4. had been looking forward
5. overslept
6. had stopped
7. left
8. had already turned
9. said
10. will improve
11. didn't believe
12. decided
13. were driving
14. poured
15. became
16. had
17. sat
18. had never felt
19. eased
20. reached

21. have always packed

Exercise 9

1. decided
2. had relied
3. wanted
4. had sent
5. called
6. woke
7. had been practising
8. felt
9. arrived
10. had already interviewed
11. waited
12. was wondering
13. opened
14. called
15. smiled
16. have decided
17. are
18. have ever met
19. have been working
20. have been enjoying
21. will use
22. will be

Exercise 10

1. was
2. had been preparing
3. trained
4. never let
5. had perfected
6. played
7. had already scored
8. were sitting
9. gave

10. are not going to lose
11. shouted
12. have come
13. will not throw
14. was
15. played
16. cheered
17. managed
18. did
19. erupted
20. had never felt
21. still remember
22. remains